



WORD FAMILIES

How words change form and function in English

1 Parts of a sentence

Subject	The person or thing the sentence is about; often the one doing the action.
Verb	A word that expresses an action or a state.
Object	A noun or pronoun that receives the action of a transitive verb.
Adjective	A word that describes a noun or pronoun. It may appear before a noun or after a linking verb.
Adverb	A word that modifies a verb, an adjective, or another adverb. Many end in -ly, but not all.

2 See the grammar working

Sentence A The talented scientist carefully developed a new method.

The	talented scientist	carefully	developed	a new method
Subject: determiner	Subject: adjective + noun	Adverb	Verb	Object (adjective + noun)

talented describes scientist; **new** describes method; **carefully** tells us how the scientist developed it.

Sentence B The scientist was successful.

The scientist = subject • was = linking verb • successful = adjective describing the subject (subject complement).

Remember Adjectives describe nouns or pronouns, not verbs. Adverbs often describe how an action happens.

3 The 11 word families

A dash (—) means there is no common, natural form for that category. Some families have more than one useful form; the examples show typical usage.

01 SUCCEED

Verb	succeed	She worked hard and succeeded.
Noun	success	The project was a success.
Adjective	successful; unsuccessful	The campaign was successful.
Adverb	successfully; unsuccessfully	They successfully completed the course.
Person noun	—	No common person noun; use a successful person.

02 HISTORY

Verb	—	No common verb directly from history.
Noun	history	We studied the history of the city.
Adjective	historic; historical	It was a historic victory. / We visited a historical museum.
Adverb	historically	Historically, this area was farmland.
Person noun	historian	The historian examined old letters.

03 RELY

Verb	rely (on)	You can rely on her advice.
Noun	reliance; reliability	Our reliance on technology has increased.
Adjective	reliable; unreliable	He is a reliable colleague.
Adverb	reliably; unreliably	The system works reliably.
Person noun	—	No common person noun.

04 ARGUE

Verb	argue	They argued about the decision.
Noun	argument	Their argument lasted an hour.
Adjective	argumentative; arguable	He's argumentative. / That claim is arguable.
Adverb	arguably; argumentatively (rare)	Arguably, this is the best solution.
Person noun	—	No common everyday person noun; use a person who argues.

05 RECOGNIZE

Verb	recognize	I recognized her voice.
Noun	recognition	She received recognition for her work.
Adjective	recognizable; recognized	His face is instantly recognizable.
Adverb	recognizably	The building is recognizably modern.
Person noun	—	No common person noun.

06 DEVELOP

Verb	develop	They developed a new method.
Noun	development	The development took several years.
Adjective	developed; developing; developmental	The country has a developed economy.
Adverb	developmentally (specific use)	The activities are developmentally appropriate.
Person noun	developer	The developer designed the application.

07 ESTABLISH

Verb	establish	They established a new school.
Noun	establishment	The establishment of the school took years.
Adjective	established	She is an established author.
Adverb	—	No common direct adverb.
Person noun	founder (related, not a derivative)	The founder established the company.

08 INTRODUCE

Verb	introduce	Let me introduce our new teacher.
Noun	introduction	The introduction was brief.

Adjective	introductory	This is an introductory course.
Adverb	—	No common direct adverb.
Person noun	introducer (uncommon)	The introducer welcomed the speaker.

09 MANUFACTURE

Verb	manufacture	The factory manufactures bicycles.
Noun	manufacture; manufacturing	The manufacture of furniture supports local jobs.
Adjective	manufactured; manufacturing	They sell manufactured goods.
Adverb	—	No common direct adverb.
Person noun	manufacturer	The manufacturer recalled the product.

10 ACCIDENT

Verb	—	Accident has no standard verb form.
Noun	accident	The accident happened yesterday.
Adjective	accidental	It was an accidental mistake.
Adverb	accidentally	I accidentally deleted the file.
Person noun	—	No common person noun.

11 INVENT

Verb	invent	She invented a useful device.
Noun	invention; inventiveness	The invention saved time.
Adjective	inventive	He found an inventive solution.
Adverb	inventively	She solved the problem inventively.
Person noun	inventor	The inventor patented the device.

4 Practice: choose the correct form

1. The experiment was a great _____. (succeed)
2. This is an important _____ event. (history)
3. We need a _____ source of information. (rely)
4. They had an _____ about the schedule. (argue)
5. The actor was immediately _____. (recognize)
6. The company hired a software _____. (develop)
7. She is an _____ expert in the field. (establish)
8. This course is designed for _____ students. (introduce)
9. The _____ produces medical equipment. (manufacture)
10. I _____ sent the email to the wrong person. (accident)
11. The _____ created a new machine. (invent)

Teacher answer key

1. success • 2. historical / historic (context-dependent) • 3. reliable • 4. argument • 5. recognizable • 6. developer • 7. established • 8. introductory • 9. manufacturer • 10. accidentally • 11. inventor